

Area is the measure of the surface of a flat figure. Area is measured using squares of a certain size. Imagine tiling a floor with square tiles. Area is the number of tiles that would cover the space.

The size of the tile determines the unit. If a tile is 1 foot on each side, it is a square foot. If no measurement is given, the tile is called a square unit.

How would you count the tiles in the figure below? The rectangle has 4 rows of 6 tiles each. The easiest way to count the tiles is to multiply: $4 \times 6 = 24$



For most two-dimensional figures, you can use this same plan. To count the squares, multiply the **base** (horizontal distance) by the **height** (vertical distance). Area is measured in square units.

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What is the area of the square?



$3 \times 3 = 9 \text{ cm}^2$ (cm $\times$ cm = cm² and is read “centimeters squared.”)

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A high school basketball court is 84 by 50 feet. What is the area in square feet?



$$84 \times 50 = 4,200 \text{ sq ft}$$

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What is the area of the parallelogram in square inches?



$$18 \times 12 = \mathbf{216 \text{ in}^2}$$
 (in² is read “inches squared” and means square inches.)

In a figure, the base and height are perpendicular. In other words, the height is at a 90° angle to the base. In the drawing of the parallelogram, the slanted sides of the parallelogram measure 13 inches, but the height is 12 inches.

To find the perimeter of a parallelogram, use the sides: $13 + 18 + 13 + 18 = 62$ inches

To find its area, use the base and height: $18 \times 12 = 216$ square inches

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Lesson 2: Perimeter and Area

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